

This newsletter - sent on Mondays, Wednesdays and Fridays - contains important information and resources to support community pharmacies across England.

In this update: Draft response to pharmacist flexibilities proposals; LFD myth busting; Winter readiness poll; Cefalexin SSPs extended; Manufacturer contingency.

Community Pharmacy England publishes draft response to pharmacist flexibilities consultation

[Learn more](#)

Community Pharmacy England has published its draft response to a Department of Health and Social Care (DHSC) consultation, stating that pharmacist flexibilities “should be the norm.”

DHSC’s proposals would allow pharmacists to supply a different strength or formulation of a prescribed medicine when the original is unavailable, under strict conditions. While broadly supportive, Community Pharmacy England’s response highlights areas where the proposals could go further to better support patient care — such as enabling pharmacists to manage branded generic prescribing.

Pharmacy owners are encouraged to submit their own responses before the consultation **closes on 11th December 2025.**

Community Pharmacy England has also submitted evidence to the House of Lords

inquiry into medicine supply issues, with Director of Research and Insights James Davies set to give oral evidence in early November.

[Read more, including James' statement](#)

A banner for the 'LFD service myth busting series'. On the left, there is a photograph of a white lateral flow device (LFD) test kit with a blue cap and a small vial. The background is a teal color with a dark teal square on the left. The text 'LFD service myth busting series' is in a large, white, sans-serif font. Below the text, there is a pink button with the text 'Read the latest series' and a white mouse cursor icon. In the bottom right corner, there is the 'Community Pharmacy England' logo, which consists of a stylized cross made of four colored squares (orange, green, blue, and red) and the text 'Community Pharmacy England' in a sans-serif font.

LFD service myth busting series

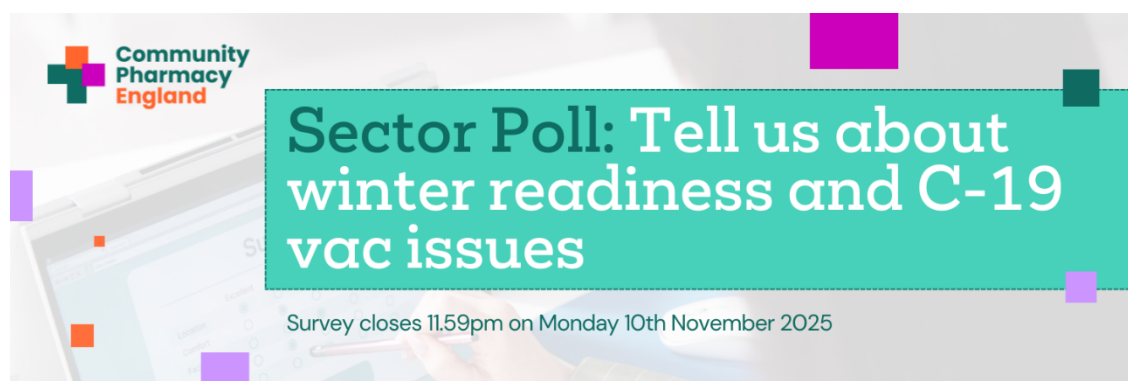
[Read the latest series](#)

Community Pharmacy England

Our Services Team has launched a series of articles tackling misconceptions about the Lateral Flow Device (LFD) Service. The latest article explores common misunderstandings around patient eligibility, including whether symptoms are required to access free test kits.

[Read the latest myth busting article](#)

[View more myths on our LFD Service page](#)

A banner for a 'Sector Poll'. The background is a light grey with a faint image of a hand holding a pen over a document. On the left, there is the 'Community Pharmacy England' logo. The main text 'Sector Poll: Tell us about winter readiness and C-19 vac issues' is in a large, white, sans-serif font. Below the main text, there is a smaller line of text: 'Survey closes 11.59pm on Monday 10th November 2025'.

Sector Poll: Tell us about winter readiness and C-19 vac issues

Survey closes 11.59pm on Monday 10th November 2025

[Take part on our poll now: What are your views and concerns for the coming winter season?](#)

Cefalexin oral suspensions sugar free SSPs further extended

DHSC has announced a further extension of the Serious Shortage Protocols (SSPs) for Cefalexin 125mg/5ml oral suspension sugar free (SSP077) and Cefalexin 250mg/5ml oral suspension sugar free (SSP078). Due to continuing supply issues, both SSPs will now be in place until **28th November 2025**.

[More details](#)

Manufacturer stock ordering contingency arrangements

Some manufacturers have put contingency arrangements in place to report issues and/or provide alternative options when ordering stock via established distribution channels becomes difficult.

Community Pharmacy England regularly helps cascade information from manufacturers to support access to their products. For example, a recent website update includes a reminder about ordering Paxlovid® (COVID-19 antiviral), with details on the correct PIP-code and Pfizer's customer service contact in case stock isn't available via Alliance Healthcare.

[See our manufacturer contingency arrangements page](#)



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